

TOPIC 4: THE STUDY OF COLOURS (PART 1)

1. Meaning of Colour

Colour is the visual sensation produced when light reflects from a surface and is seen by the eye. In art, colour is a major element used to express mood, create contrast and organise design.

2. Classification of Colours

- **Primary colours** – red, yellow, blue (cannot be mixed from other colours).
- **Secondary colours** – orange, green, purple (mixed from two primaries).
- **Tertiary colours** – mixtures of a primary and a neighbouring secondary (e.g. red-orange).
- **Neutral colours** – black, white, grey, and sometimes brown.

3. Mixing of Colours

Mixing primaries produces secondaries. Adding white lightens (tint); adding black darkens (shade). Practise mixing to get the exact hue you need.

4. Importance of Colour in Painting and Design

Colour attracts attention, creates mood (warm vs cool), shows depth and form, and carries cultural and symbolic meaning. Good colour choice improves the impact of any design.

5. Summary

Colour is classified into primary, secondary, tertiary and neutral. Mixing and careful use of colour are essential skills in painting and design.

End of Topic 4